

Joy Dhar

DEEP LEARNING RESEARCHER | PH.D. SCHOLAR IN COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING · IIT ROPAR

Kolkata, India

☎ (+91) 8777091225 | ✉ joy.22csz0003@iitrpr.ac.in | 📱 misti1203 | 📠 joy-dhar-42930a248 | 📧 Joy Dhar

“Building effective and reliable AI for those who need it most—not just where data is abundant, but also where care is scarce.”

Summary

Ph.D. Scholar and Deep Learning Researcher at IIT Ropar working at the intersection of Efficient AI, Multimodal AI, and Trustworthy AI for health-care, with a focus on heterogeneous medical data, including medical imaging, multi-omics, electronic health records, and time-series signals. My work, published in top-tier venues, aims to advance scientific discovery and translate cutting-edge research into real-world clinical decision-support systems for resource-constrained medical AI applications.

Research Interests

ML Foundations: Supervised, self-supervised, unsupervised, and continual learning; distribution-shift robustness; knowledge distillation.

Multimodal AI: Multimodal representation learning and fusion; multimodal and cross-modal attention; vision-language models.

Trustworthy AI: Adversarial Attacks; Certified & Empirical Adversarial Robustness; Curriculum Learning.

Generative AI: Generative adversarial networks; diffusion models; autoencoders; variational autoencoders.

Healthcare AI: Efficient medical image analysis; heterogeneous clinical data modeling; disease classification and segmentation.

Publications

Conference

1. **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, N. Zaidi, C. Chen, M. Haghighat, F. Sohel, and P. Goyal, “Advancing Multimodal Fusion on Heterogeneous Medical Data with Hybrid Geometry Attention,” in Proc. of the **ACM SIGKDD Conference, 2026 (Accepted)**.
2. **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, B. Bozorgtabar, N. Zaidi, W. Zhang, W. H. Li, T. Mu, D. Mahapatra, M. Baktashmotlagh, T. Le, C. Chen, S. Mistry, C. Gonzalez, S. E. Kahou, L. Yao, P. Koniusz, R.B. Fisher, D. Phung, B. Han, N. Vasconcelos, and P. Lio, “Does a Hybrid Space-Aware Randomized Defense Improve Empirical and Certified Adversarial Robustness?,” **ICML 2026 (Accepted)**.
3. **J. Dhar**, S. Xia, M. Pandey, M. Haghighat, A. Alavi, F. Sohel, W. Zhang, and N. Zaidi, “Certified VS. Empirical adversarial robustness via hybrid convolutions with attention stochasticity,” **ICLR 2026**.
4. **J. Dhar**, N. Zaidi, M. Haghighat, “Effective and Robust Multimodal Medical Image Analysis,” in Proc. of the **ACM SIGKDD Conference, 2026**.
5. **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, D. Chakladar, M. Haghighat, A. Alavi, S. Mistry, N. Zaidi, “HyPCA-Net: Advancing Multimodal Fusion in Medical Image Analysis,” in Proc. **IEEE/CVF Winter Conf. on Applications of Computer Vision (WACV)**, 2026.
6. **J. Dhar**, N. Zaidi, M. Haghighat, S. Roy, P. Goyal, A. Alavi, and V. Kumar, “Multimodal fusion learning with dual attention for medical imaging,” in Proc. **IEEE/CVF Winter Conf. on Applications of Computer Vision (WACV)**, 2025.
7. **J. Dhar**, K. Rana, and P. Goyal, “Uncertainty-aware robust information fusion attention network for brain tumors classification in MRI images,” in Proc. **2024 Int. Conf. on Pattern Recognition (ICPR)**, 2024.
8. M. S. Kanroo, H. S. Kawoosa, **J. Dhar**, and P. Goyal, “PiExtract: an end-to-end data extraction pipeline for pie charts,” in Proc. **2024 Int. Conf. on Pattern Recognition (ICPR)**, 2024.

Journal

1. **J. Dhar**, P. Goyal, M. Haghighat, N. Zaidi, F. Sohel, Q. B. Vo, and K. C. Santosh, “Towards building robust models for unimodal and multimodal medical imaging data,” **Information Fusion**, 2026.
2. **J. Dhar**, K. Rana, P. Goyal, A. Alavi, R. Rana, Q. B. Vo, S. Mishra, and S. Mistry, “Dual-phase neural networks for feature extraction and ensemble learning for recognizing human health activities,” **Applied Soft Computing**, 2025.
3. **J. Dhar**, and S. Roy, “Identification and diagnosis of cervical cancer using a hybrid feature selection approach with the Bayesian optimization-based optimized CatBoost classification algorithm,” **Journal of Ambient Intelligence and Humanized Computing**, 2024.
4. **J. Dhar**, “An adaptive intelligent diagnostic system to predict early stage of Parkinson’s disease using two-stage dimension reduction with genetically optimized LightGBM algorithm,” **Neural Computing & Applications**, 2022.
5. **J. Dhar** and N. A. Ayele, “Multi-tier ensemble learning model with neighborhood component analysis to predict health diseases,” **IEEE Access**, 2021.
6. **J. Dhar**, “Multistage ensemble learning model with weighted voting and genetic algorithm optimization strategy for detecting chronic obstructive pulmonary disease,” **IEEE Access**, 2021.

Manuscripts Under Review

Conference Submissions

- 1 **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, D. Mahapatra, P. Koniusz, N. Zaidi, I. Razzak, B. Bozorgtabar, C. Sun, J. Yang, M. Reyes, Z. Ge, L. Yao, M. Baktashmotlagh, A. Farshad, I. Banerjee, W. Zhang, M. Fiaz, C. Gonzalez, R. Narava, A. Shekhar, V. Gupta, E. Yang, H. Müller, K. Åström, N. Vasconcelos, P. Lio, "Can Multimodal Fusion of Heterogeneous Medical Data Accelerate Convergence?," submitted to **ECCV 2026**, manuscript under review.
- 2 D. Mahapatra, A. Das, M. Pandey, **J. Dhar**, S. Roy, Z. Ge, B. Bozorgtabar, and I. Razzak, "Proximity-Constrained Counterfactual Decoding for Hallucination-Robust Medical VQA," submitted to **ECCV 2026**, manuscript under review.
- 3 **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, N. Zaidi, W. H. Li, W. Zhang, B. Bozorgtabar, D. Mahapatra, T. Mu, C. Chen, C. Gonzalez, T. V. Nguyen, M. Yang, C. Sun, E. Yang, N. Aghaeepour, M. Baktashmotlagh, D. Phung, R.B. Fisher, C. Davatzikos, "DEMAAnD: Redefining Decoder Design to Advance Medical Image Segmentation," submitted to **ECCV 2026**, manuscript under review.
- 4 **J. Dhar**, D. Chakladar, M. Pandey, D. Mahapatra, N. Zaidi, B. Bozorgtabar, I. Razzak, H. Mokayed, P. Goyal, "GCARE: Advancing Multimodal Fusion on Heterogeneous Medical Data," submitted to **ECCV 2026**, manuscript under review.
- 5 **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, P. Goyal, B. Bozorgtabar, P. Liu, D. Mahapatra, and P. Lio, "CoVANT: Advancing Multimodal Fusion on Heterogeneous Medical Data," submitted to **NeurIPS 2026**, manuscript under review.
- 6 **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, P. Goyal, D. Mahapatra, and P. Lio, "GSAND: Hybrid-Space Attention Advances Medical Image Segmentation," submitted to **NeurIPS 2026**, manuscript under review.
- 7 **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, P. Goyal, D. Mahapatra, and P. Lio, "Certified vs. Empirical Adversarial Robustness in Multimodal Fusion via Hybrid Space Convolutional Stochasticity," submitted to **NeurIPS 2026**, manuscript under review.
- 8 D. Mahapatra, A. Das, **J. Dhar**, M. Pandey, Z. Ge, B. Bozorgtabar, and I. Razzak, "Transductive Conformal Decoding: Controlling Hallucinations in Multimodal Generation," submitted to **NeurIPS 2026**, manuscript under review.

Journal Submissions

- 1 **J. Dhar**, D. Chakladar, M. Pandey, D. Mahapatra, B. Bozorgtabar, I. Razzak, and P. Goyal, "Can Hybrid-Space Representation Learning Advance Multimodal Fusion?," manuscript in preparation for submission to *Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR)*.
- 2 **J. Dhar**, P. Goyal, and F. Soheli, "MANAT: Multimodal attention noise injection with adversarial training for adversarial robustness in medical image analysis," submitted to *Applied Soft Computing*, manuscript under review.

Education

Indian Institute of Technology Ropar (IIT Ropar)

PH.D. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

- Advisor: Dr. Puneet Goyal; Institute Scholarship Recipient

Punjab, India

Jul. 2022--Jun. 2027

Maulana Abul Kalam Azad University of Technology

M.TECH. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

- CGPA 8.92/10 (A+); ranked 3rd in the department

West Bengal, India

Aug. 2015--Nov. 2017

West Bengal University of Technology

B.TECH. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

- CGPA 8.59/10 (A+); ranked 10th in the department

West Bengal, India

Aug. 2009--Nov. 2012

Awards & Honors

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|------|---|------------------|
| 2025 | Recipient , Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) Travel Fund to present at WACV 2025 | Tucson, USA |
| 2024 | Winner , IEEE Video and Image Processing (VIP) Cup at ICIP | Abu Dhabi, UAE |
| 2011 | Finalist , IBM India The Great Mind Challenge (TGMC) Project | Bangalore, India |

Scholarships/Fellowships

INTERNATIONAL

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| 2022 | Deakin University Postgraduate Research Scholarship , Deakin University | Australia |
| 2022 | Industrial Scholarship for Ph.D., Big Data and High-Performance Computing , University of Genoa | Italy |
| 2022 | Ph.D. Institute Scholarship , University of Salerno | Italy |
| 2022 | JCU Postgraduate Research Stipend Scholarship , James Cook University | Australia |
| 2021 | Ph.D. Institute Scholarship , National Taipei University of Technology | Taiwan |
| 2021 | Ph.D. Institute Scholarship , National Dong Hwa University | Taiwan |
| 2021 | Elite Doctoral Scholarship , National Sun Yat-sen University | Taiwan |

DOMESTIC

- 2022 **Ph.D. Institute Scholarship**, Indian Institute of Technology Dhanbad
- 2022 **Ph.D. Institute Scholarship**, Indian Institute of Technology Ropar
- 2019 **NET Fellowship**, NTA-UGC
- 2018 **GATE Fellowship**, M.H.R.D.

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Current Projects

Does a Hybrid Space-Aware Weight Refiner Improve Multimodal Fusion Robustness?

Punjab, India

DEVSING HYBRID SPACE AWARE ATTENTION FOR MULTIMODAL FUSION

Feb. 2026

- Devised a hybrid space aware weight refinement module that incorporates both implicit and explicit refinement process to improve multimodal fusion robustness.

Robust-Zero: A Defense Framework for Zero-Shot Classification

Punjab, India

DEVELOPING A ZERO-SHOT DEFENSE FRAMEWORK USING RANDOM FILTERS, ATTENTION NOISE, AND FEATURE

May 2025

DISENTANGLEMENT

- Jointly exploit random filtering, attention-noise injection, and disentangled feature representations to mitigate vulnerabilities.

Academic Services

- 2021–2026 **PC member/Reviewer**, NeurIPS; CVPR; AAAI; KDD; ACM MM; WACV; ICPR; ASOC; NCAA; Scientific Reports
- 2022–2027 **Teaching Assistant**, Indian Institute of Technology Ropar
- 2021–2022 **Research Assistant**, National Sun Yat-sen University
- 2016–2021 **Information Technology Teacher**, Hatgobindapur M. C. High School
- 2014–2016 **Lecturer in Computer Science & Technology**, JLD College of Engineering & Management

India & Taiwan
Punjab, India
Kaohsiung, Taiwan
Burdwan, India
Kolkata, India

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, C/C++, Java, C#, PHP, MATLAB;

Frameworks: TensorFlow/Keras, PyTorch, scikit-learn;

Data Analysis: NumPy, Pandas, OpenCV, SciPy;

Tools & Platforms: LaTeX, Jupyter, Kaggle, Google Colab, VS Code.

Selected Coursework

Deep Learning
Internet of Things

Computer Vision
Pattern Recognition

Advanced Computer Vision
Artificial Intelligence

Digital Image Processing
Data Structures & Algorithms

References

Dr. Puneet Goyal

Associate Professor (Ph.D. Supervisor)
Department of Computer Science & Engineering
IIT Ropar, Punjab, India
Email: puneet@iitrpr.ac.in

Phone: +91 74175 32043

Dr. Dwarikanath Mahapatra

Assistant Professor (Co-Author)
Department of Computer Science
Khalifa University, UAE
Email: dwarikanath.mahapatra@ku.ac.ae

Phone: +971 2 312 3888

Dr. Nayyar Zaidi

Senior Lecturer (Co-Author)
School of Information Technology
Deakin University, Australia
Email: nayyar.zaidi@deakin.edu.au

Phone: +61 3 9244 5963

Dr. Azadeh Alavi

Lecturer (Co-Author)
School of Computing Technologies
RMIT University, Australia
Email: azadeh.alavi@rmit.edu.au

Phone: +61 3 9925 2000